

Media Pitch & Press Release Template

Journalist-tested templates for getting your campaign covered.

Cold Pitch Email Template

SUBJECT: [SPECIFIC ANGLE IN 7 WORDS] — [LOCATION] Hi [JOURNALIST FIRST NAME], [HOOK: One sentence — why this story matters RIGHT NOW to their readers.] [PROOF: A statistic, document, or verifiable fact that makes the hook credible.] [STORY: One specific person or incident that humanizes the issue.] [EXCLUSIVITY: Why you are bringing this to them specifically.] I can make available: * On-the-record spokesperson: [NAME, TITLE] * Documents: [DESCRIBE — FOIA records, internal emails, etc.] * Community members willing to speak on record * Expert sources: [NAME, CREDENTIAL] Available for a 10-minute call. When works for you? [YOUR NAME / TITLE / ORGANIZATION / PHONE]

Press Release Template

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE [CONTACT NAME] [PHONE] [EMAIL]
[REDACTED] [HEADLINE — Active verb, specific, 8 words max] [SUBHEADLINE — One sentence expanding the headline] [CITY, DATE] — [LEAD PARAGRAPH: Who did What, Where, When, Why it matters. Max 75 words. If a reporter reads only this, they have the story.] [SUPPORTING PARAGRAPH: Evidence, context, specifics. Quote placed here.] "[Direct quote that makes an arguable claim]," said FirstName LastName, Title, Organization. [IMPACT PARAGRAPH: Who is affected? How many? What does this mean?] [BACKGROUND: 2–3 sentences of context.] "[Second quote — from a community member, not a spokesperson]," said [NAME, TITLE]. ### ABOUT [ORGANIZATION]: [2 sentences — what you do, who you serve.] ADDITIONAL RESOURCES: [Document download URL] | [Photo/video available: YES/NO]

Media Contact Tracker

Journalist	Outlet	Beat	Contact	Date Pitched	Response	Published?

Hook Formulas That Work

Formula	Example
The Number	"183 families received eviction notices in a single month in Norfolk"
The Document	"Internal emails obtained by IRN show the department knew about the contamination for 2 years"
The Pattern	"At least 6 people reported the same officer — none resulted in discipline"

Formula	Example
The Contradiction	"The mayor said the program serves everyone. FOIA records show 94% of recipients are white"
The Deadline	"The city council votes Thursday. Residents say they don't know what is in the proposal"
<i>TIP: Local news first. City council reporters, housing beat, and criminal justice reporters at local papers are your primary targets. National coverage follows local coverage.</i>	